

Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

♠ A 2
♥ Q 9 8 3
♦ 7 6 5 3
♣ 10 9 7

♠ K Q 9 8 6 4
♥ A J 2
♦ 8
♣ 6 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 7
♥ 10 7 5 4
♦ A 9 4 2
♣ K Q J 3

♠ J 10 5 3
♥ K 6
♦ K Q J 10
♣ A 8 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			

North is to play 4 ♠. East leads the ♣K.

Losers: ♠=1 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 4

The ♣ lead was terrible for you as it exposes your 2 ♣ losers before you can establish a ♦ for a discard. If you start to pull trumps now the defense will grab their ♠A, their 2 ♣s and their ♦A.

If you try to establish a ♦ they will do the same thing, just in a different order. What does that leave you?

Losers: ♠=1 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 4

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It leaves you trying the only possible way you can make this contract, finessing West for the ♥Q to get a ♣ discard from dummy.

You win the ♣A in dummy, play the ♥K, then return a ♥ to your ♥J. You then discard a ♣ from dummy on the ♥A.

When you have only one chance to make your contract you take it.

This time it worked, another time it might not.

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ A 7 5 3
♥ 10 7 3
♦ K 9 8
♣ A 9 6

♠ Q J 10 9

♥ Q J 8

♦ 6 5 2

♣ 8 4 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 8 6 4 2

♥ -

♦ J 10 7 3

♣ Q J 10 2

♠ -

♥ A K 9 6 5 4 2

♦ A Q 4

♣ K 7 5

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1 ♥
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			

4 ♥ by South

Now play the ♠ Q and when East plays low, discard a ♣. This is a loser on loser play and West takes the trick with the ♠ A.

West now leads the ♥ 7. You cover with dummy's ♥ 8 knowing the finesse will win. Next you play dummy's ♠ J, covered by East and ruffed by you (if East didn't cover you would throw another ♣ loser). Now enter dummy with the ♥ Q, pulling West's last trump at the same time. Discard your 2 ♣s on the ♠ 10 9 and try the ♦ finesse for an overtrick.

This loser-on-loser play didn't have much to do with trump management.

Just the fact that you had to use the trump suit for entries to dummy, and therefore couldn't immediately pull trumps.

South is to play 4 ♥. West leads the ♥ 3.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=0 ♦=2 ♣=3 Total = 5

If East has the ♦ K, one ♦ loser can be eliminated by a finesse. And, if East also has the ♣ A one more loser can be eliminated by leading toward your ♣ K. The chance of both cards being held by East isn't very good, only about 25%. But dummy has some nice ♠s. Can you use them?

Yes, you can establish 2 ♠ winners for discards, and most importantly, you can do it without letting East into the lead. This is important because if East gets in and plays a ♣ through your ♣ K 7 5 it might be a disaster.

So win the ♥ J in dummy. Uh-Oh, East discards a ♠.

Board 5

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 5 2
 ♥ 10 9 3
 ♦ J 9 5 3
 ♣ K Q 8

♠ A Q J 9 7 4

♥ A 6

♦ A Q

♣ 6 3 2



♠ 8 3

♥ K Q J 7

♦ 10 6 4

♣ A J 10 7

♠ K 6

♥ 8 5 4 2

♦ K 8 7 2

♣ 9 5 4

West	North	East	South
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	1NT
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			

4 ♠ by North

... except when you have a good reason not to, like here.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=1 ♦=0 ♣=3 Total = 4

This is a very easy problem to be up here at number 18! Clearly you have to discard one of those 4 losers on the only card dummy has, the ♦ K.

Just as clearly you have to be able to enter dummy after you unblock the ♦ A Q so you can't pull trumps immediately.

So here's the Plan. Win the ♥ A. Pull one round of trumps with the ♠ A. Play the ♦ A Q to get them out of the way. Enter dummy with the ♠ K. Play the ♦ K, discard a loser, and hope nobody ruffs.

Just remember to always pull trumps immediately . . .